

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



MODULE - 18

**CIVIL SERVICES
POLICY**

BRITISH RAJ

Three pillars on which the British administration of India was based are:-

**CIVIL
SERVICES**

POLICE

ARMY



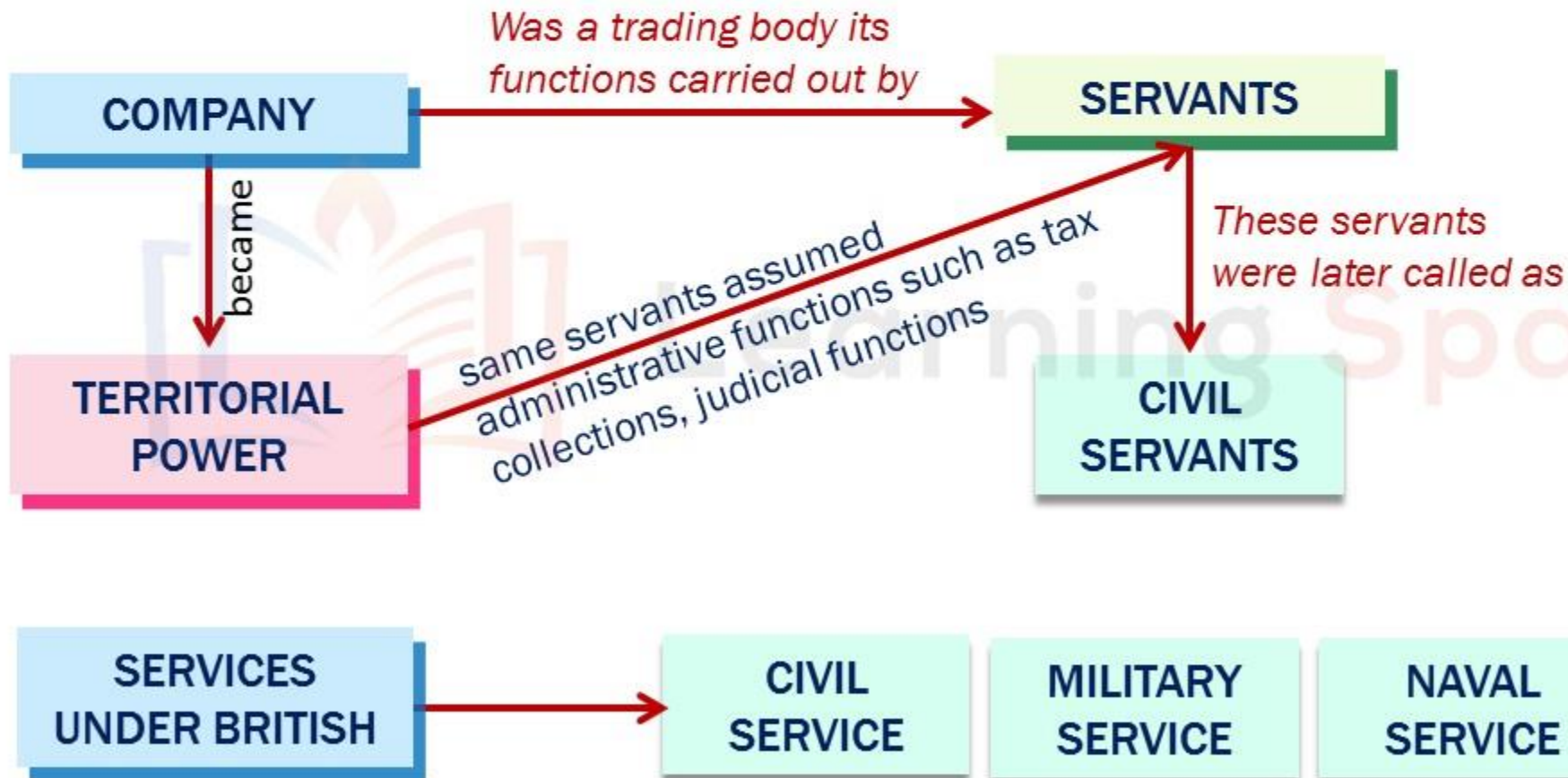
Civil Service



CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

ORIGIN OF CIVIL SERVICES

Civil service is a public service executed through government appointed officials.
The civil service system introduced in India by the British East India Company



Civil service was one of the strongest pillar of the British Empire. It is "HEAVEN-BORN" service much boasted as the "steel frame of the Raj".

THEORY

ORIGIN OF CIVIL SERVICES



ENGLISH CIVIL SERVANTS

During EIC, trade of the company was carried through servants of the company.

Later when company became territorial power same servants assumed administrative functions such as tax collections, judicial functions and departments like home, school etc.

Over period of time, **civil service became the backbone** of country and they were vested with huge responsibilities.

In the beginning, the term 'civil service' was used to distinguish the servants of the Company engaged in commercial affairs from those people employed in the military and naval services.

WHY THERE WAS NEED TO BRING REFORMS IN CIVIL SERVICES?

Due to unaccounted accounts and cheat practices, corruption and inefficiency erupted into the functioning of the company management.

MISUSE OF PRIVILEGES

- Misuse of **dastaks**
- Misuse of **trading rights**
- Misuse of **treaty** made with native states.

COLLUSION

- Initially they were paid low, but allowed to go for private trade.
- Later when they assumed administrative functions they **colluded with traders and merchants** and became extremely corrupt.

Company management, trade unions and civil servants conspired into a triple alliance. At times they united their forces to thwart any attempts made for any just cause.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

INTRODUCTION

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORM



1765-1858

UNDER THE COMPANY RULE

UNDER ROBERT CLIVE AND
WARREN HASTINGS

UNDER LORD CORNWALLIS, 1793

UNDER LORD WELLESLEY, 1800

CHARTER ACT OF 1833

CHARTER ACT OF 1853

1858- 1947



UNDER THE BRITISH CROWN

INDIAN CIVIL SERVICES ACT, 1861

UNDER LORD LYTTON, 1878

ITCHISON COMMITTEE ON , 1886

1893 RESOLUTION

ISLINGTON COMMISSION, 1912

MONTFORD REFORMS, 1919

LEE COMMISSION, 1924

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT 1935

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

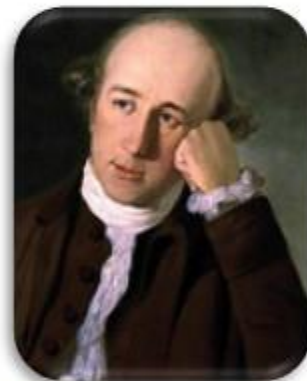
REFORMS UNDER ROBERT CLIVE AND WARREN HASTINGS DURING 1765-1784

Many attempts were made by then **Governors like Robert Clive and Warren Hastings** to purify the system. But it was partially attained.



ROBERT CLIVE
(1765-1772)

To check corruption in company, **Robert Clive** increased the salary of servants and prevented them to accept bribes or present.



WARREN HASTINGS
(1773-1785)

Warren Hastings made an attempt to separate Administrative and Commercial branches.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

REFORMS UNDER LORD CORNWALLIS, 1793



LORD CORNWALLIS
(1786-1793)

Lord Cornwallis was the first to establish and organized civil service so he was known as the 'Father of Civil Service in India'

Later **major reform** was brought during **Cornwallis** in **1793**. He was determined to purify the system and hence made some overhauling reforms.

Cornwallis **divided** civil service post into two categories

1. **Covenanted Civil Services**
2. **Uncovenanted Civil Services**

Covenanted civil services are the **higher** Posts reserved for **British**.

Enter service with agreement

Uncovenanted post were the **lower post** for which **Indians** were recruited

No agreement- hired and fired anytime

REFORMS UNDER LORD CORNWALLIS, 1793



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REFORMS UNDER LORD CORNWALLIS, 1793

WHY CORNWALLIS EXCLUDED INDIANS FROM HIGHER POST?

There was **belief** that only English person could **establish administrative services** and **can serve British interests**.

There was **belief** that Indians were

- Incapable
- Untrustworthy and
- Insensitive to the British interests

Cornwallis believed that- "**every native of Hindustan is corrupt**".

Sense of racial superiority and belief that English belong to exclusive club.

There was **high competition among Europeans** themselves for lucrative posts, so why offer them to Indians.

British were holding such mythical rationale **in order to legitimize their own monopoly of power**.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

REFORMS UNDER LORD WELLESLEY, 1800

- **Fort William college in Calcutta** was established in 1800 for the education of young recruits and trained them in **Indian tradition and language**.
- 3 years of training was given before getting civil posting.



- Later Court of Directors disapproved this college in 1806 and replaced it by **East Indian college at Hailey bury in England**.
- This college was abolished in 1858 because by this time ownership was transferred from company to the crown.



Why Fort William college was disapproved? Court of Director felt that such training program might result in loyalties of civil servants shifting from London to Calcutta.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

REFORMS UNDER VARIOUS ACT

CHARTER ACT OF 1833

Open competition was **theoretically introduced**, but it was negated due to opposition by court of directors.

Nomination cum competition i.e. 4 times the vacancies were nominated by COD and only nominated candidates can appear for examination

CHARTER ACT OF 1853

Technically open competition was introduced and recruitment was based on merit. Thus equal opportunity for Indians was given.

So Nomination process was replaced by competition

POINTS TO PONDER

WHY OPEN COMPETITION WAS INTRODUCED 1853?

There was a **growing demand** by **Indian educated class** for introduction of Indians into administration.



Civil Service

By 1850s, there was also **change in the attitude of the British Government** to bring Indians into administration.

- 1** To **correct the discrimination and injustice** being done against Indians as per Lord Cornwallis code of 1793.
- 2** Law member, Macaulay recommended **appointment** to the civil service of the company **should not be matter of favours but a matter of right**.
- 3** **Globally British** wanted to show that they have concern for their colonies.

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REFORMS UNDER VARIOUS ACT

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT, 1858

Via GoI Act, 1858
proclamation
Indians were allowed
to freely and
impartially included
in offices under civil
service.

INDIAN CIVIL SERVICES ACT, 1861

- Now civil services was called as ICS.
- Act reserved certain offices for covenanted civil servants i.e. principal posts were reserved for British.
- Examination was held in England in English language (effectively barring Indians)

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

BY 1871 ONLY 3 INDIANS WERE SELECTED FOR CIVIL SERVICE



SATYENDRA NATH TAGORE
FIRST INDIAN TO QUALIFY IN 1863



R.C. DUTTA



BIHARI LAL GUPTA

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

BARRIERS FOR INDIAN

Although Indians had begun to enter the coveted ranks of ICS ever since 1863, entering civil services was still extremely difficult for Indians.

SYLLABUS ISSUE

The entrance examination for ICS was in **English medium only**, and subjects included classical Greek and Latin learning.

AGE ISSUE

Maximum age for appearing at exam was reduced from 23 in 1859 to 19 in 1878 under Lytton. Later kept at increased to 23.

INDIANISATION ISSUE

All **key positions of power and authority** and those which were well-paid were **occupied by Europeans**.

SIMULTANEOUS EXAMINATION

Exam was held in England. Indians were demanding that exam should be conducted both in England and India simultaneously.

OPEN COMPETITION

Indians were demanding that there should be equal opportunity in matter of appointment through open competition.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

DISCUSSION AND DEBATE OVER AGE

1859

Maximum permissible age was 23.

1860

Maximum permissible age was 22.

1866

Maximum permissible age was 21.

1878

Maximum permissible age was 19.

Maximum permissible age was gradually reduced from 1859 to 1878 until, in 1886 it was again increased to 23.

Main aim was to exclude Indians

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

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REFORMS UNDER LORD LYTTON, 1878-79

His reforms are also called as **Statutory civil services reforms**.



LORD LYTTON
(1876-1880)

It consist of **one-sixth of covenanted posts to be filled by Indians of high families through nominations** by local governments subject to approval by the secretary of State and the viceroy.

It was a step towards Indianisation of civil service but it failed because

- Indians were demanding open competition not nomination
- There were high chances of nepotism and favoritism

So this system was abolished

Maximum permissible age reduced to 19 .

In response to Lytton measures, Indian association headed by **Surendranath Banerjee** launched an agitation all over the country

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS DEMANDS BY INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS



LORD DUFFERIN
(1884-1888)

BACKGROUND

In 1885, INC demanded

- Indianisation of Civil services.
- Against lowering of age limit for recruitment,
- Holding the examination simultaneously in India and Britain

Indians came to realize that Indianisation of civil service had not, in any way, transferred effective power into Indian hands. The Indian members of the civil service continued to serve the imperialist interests of their British masters.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

REFORMS UNDER DUFFERIN

AITCHISON COMMITTEE ON , 1886

RECOMMENDATION

Abolishing
statutory civil
service

Dropping of terms
covenanted and
uncovenanted

Classification
of Civil
service into

Raising
age limit
to 23.



AITCHISON

Imperial Indian civil
services
(examination in
England)

Provincial civil
services
(examination
in India)

Subordinate
civil services
(examination
in India)

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

1893 RESOLUTION

After Aitchison committee, this resolution supported holding of simultaneous examination in India and England; but was never implemented.

REASON 1

Kimberley, the secretary of state, made a statement that, "It is indispensable that an adequate number of members of civil service shall always be Europeans."

REASON 2

It would be discriminatory to have an open competition as Hindu elite, a traditionally learnt class, will monopolize the civil services excluding Sikhs or Muslims.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

ISLINGTON COMMISSION, 1912

RECOMMENDATION

Three grounds-

HOLDING SIMULTANEOUS EXAMINATION IN LONDON AND INDIA- It rejected demand on grounds like **uneven development of quality education among various sections**, communities and provinces of India. Moreover, the commission was more concerned about maintaining the British character of administration

SALARY STRUCTURE- to attract Englishmen to the services it **suggested higher rates of pay for Europeans** than for Indians for the same service.

OPEN COMPETITION-CUM NOMINATION It suggested that **75%** of the ICS officers should **be recruited in England** by open competition and the remaining **25%** **were to be filled in India** by nomination

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

MONTFORD REFORMS (1919)

RECOMMENDATION

Stated a realistic policy—"If a responsible government is to be established in India, the more Indians is to be employed."

Recommended holding of simultaneous examination in India and England which were held in 1922.

Recommended that 33% of recruitments be made in India itself—to be raised annually by 1.5 per cent.

CIVIL SERVICE REFORMS

EVOLUTION OF CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS

VISCOUNT LEE COMMISSION (1924)

RECOMMENDATION

The **secretary of state** should **continue to recruit** officers of services- ICS, Indian Engineers service (IES)(Irrigation branch), Indian Forest Service(IFS), etc.

The **recruitments** for the **transferred fields** like **education** and **civil medical service** be **made** by **provincial governments**

- **Public Service Commission** should be immediately established (as laid down in the Government of India Act, 1919)
- Later it was established in 1926.

Direct recruitment to ICS on basis of **50:50** parity between the **Europeans** and the **Indians** be reached in 15 years;

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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT, 1935

RECOMMENDED ESTABLISHMENT OF

FEDERAL
PUBLIC SERVICE
COMMISSION

PROVINCIAL
PUBLIC SERVICE
COMMISSION

But still now the positions of control and authority remained in British hands. Indian bureaucrats acted as the agents of colonial rule.

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**CIVIL
SERVICES**



POLICE



ARMY



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